NPTEL ONLINE CERTIFICATION COURSES



Course Name: Software Project Management

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TOPIC: Project Evaluation and Programme Management cont…



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CONCEPTS COVERED

- Programme management
- Benefits Management



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Programme management

- Definition of programme:

  'a group of projects that are managed in a co-ordinated way to gain benefits that would not be possible were the projects to be managed independently'

  By D. C. Ferns





Different types of Programmes

- Strategic :projects implementing a single strategy
- Business cycle programmes: projects that an organization undertakes within a planning cycle
- Infrastructure programmes: projects performing the activities of identifying common infrastructure and its implementation and maintenance
- Research and development programmes: projects involved in developing new innovative products based on some research
- Innovative partnerships: projects based on collaboration by different organizations.





Programme managers versus project managers

Programme manager

- Many simultaneous projects
- Personal relationship with skilled resources
- Optimization of resource use
- Projects tend to be seen as similar

Project manager

- One project at a time
- Impersonal relationship with resources
- Minimization of demand for resources
- Projects tend to be seen as unique





Strategic programmes

- It is a different form of programme management where portfolio of projects all contribute to a common objective
- Based on OGC (Office of Government commerce) approach





Strategic programmes

- Initial planning document is the **Programme Mandate** describing
  - The new services/capabilities that the programme should deliver
  - How an organization will be improved
  - Fit with existing organizational goals
- A **programme director** appointed a champion for the scheme





Next stages/documents

- **The programme brief** – equivalent of a feasibility study: emphasis on costs and benefits
- **The vision statement** – explains the new capability that the organization will have
- **The blueprint** – explains the changes to be made to obtain the new capability





Aids to programme management

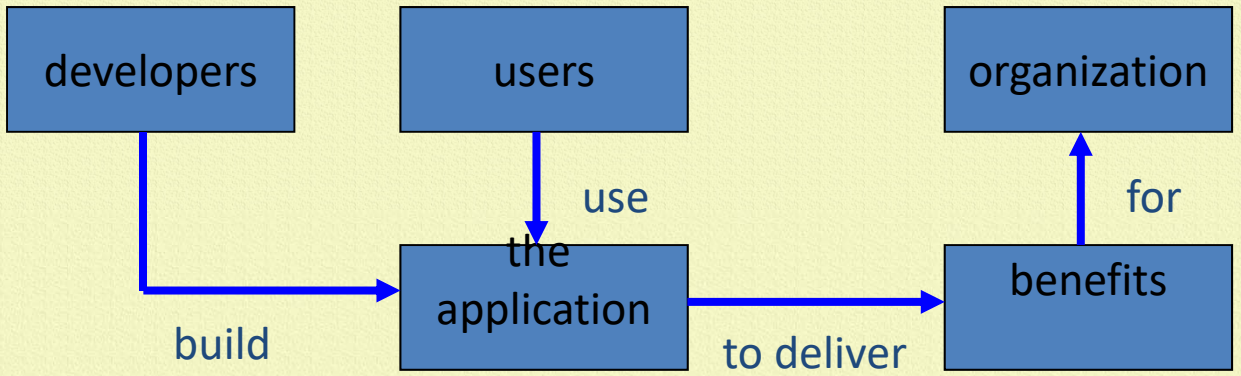
- There may be physical and technical dependencies between projects
- This can be represented using dependency diagrams which are similar to activity networks





Benefits management

- Providing an organization with a capability does not guarantee that this will provide benefits envisaged – need for *benefits management*
- This has to be outside the project – project will have been completed
- Therefore done at *programme level*



Benefits management cont…

To carry this out, you must:

- Define expected benefits
- Analyse balance between costs and benefits
- Plan how benefits will be achieved
- Allocate responsibilities for their achievement
- Monitor achievement of benefits





Benefits

These might include:

- Mandatory requirement
- Improved quality of service
- Increased productivity
- More motivated workforce
- Internal management benefits





Benefits - continued

- Risk reduction
- Economies
- Revenue enhancement/acceleration
- Strategic fit



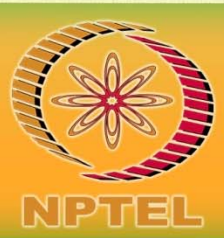


Quantifying benefits

Benefits can be:

- Quantified and valued e.g. a reduction of *x* staff saving *£y*
- Quantified but not valued e.g. a decrease in customer complaints by *x%*
- Identified but not easily quantified – e.g. public approval for a organization in the locality where it is based





Summary

- Discussed about programmes and programme management
- Discussed about benefits and benefits management





References :

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